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Which column finds the trend?

How to read the Most active card's test, column by column, with simple pictures and the numbers from your own screen. No maths background needed.

The question this test answers

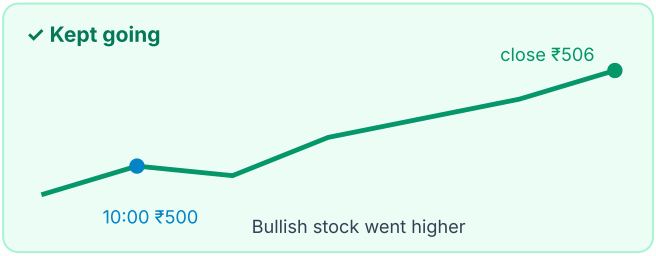
The Most active card shows many columns: volume vs usual, money traded, buyer / seller imbalance, speed, and so on. If you sort the stocks by one of them and take the top ones, **do those stocks keep moving the same way for the rest of the day**, more often than an average stock? If yes, that column helps you find a trend. If not, sorting by it is only noise.

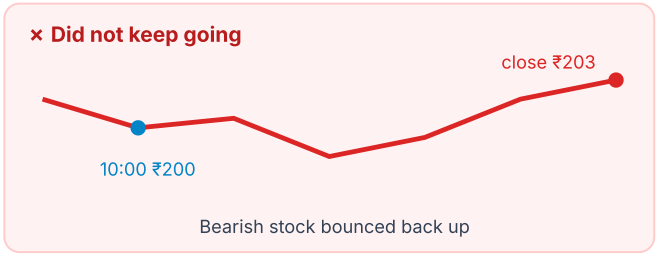
1. What the test does, in one picture



The same is done at every time you tick (10:00, 11:00 ... 14:00), on every past day with saved scans, for every column.

What "kept going" means





A **bullish** stock (up on the day at the check time) "kept going" if it was **higher** later. A **bearish** stock (down on the day) "kept going" if it was **lower** later. The "close" is the day's last saved scan (15:10 or later).

2. The small table at the top: "Best for ..."

For each time (and for all times together) it names the column whose top stocks kept going most often, and only if it beat all the stocks. From your screen:

TIME	BEST FOR BULLISH AND BEARISH	BEST FOR BULLISH ONLY	BEST FOR BEARISH ONLY
All times	Buyer / seller imbalance 54% vs 36%	Volume vs usual 81% vs 68%	Buyer / seller imbalance 31% vs 11%
10:00	none better than all stocks	none	none
14:00	Buyer / seller imbalance 68% vs 47%	none	none

How to say "Buyer / seller imbalance 54% vs 36%" in plain words

"When I picked the stocks with the most buyers waiting (for up-stocks) or most sellers waiting (for down-stocks), **54 out of every 100** picks were still moving their way at the close. Picking any stock at random, only **36 out of 100** did."

"none better than all stocks" means: at that time, no column's top picks beat the plain average. At 10:00, 11:00 and 12:00 on your days, sorting by any column did not help.

3. The big table, column by column

Each row is one Most active column that was tested. Here is every header, with the numbers from the first row of your screen (**Buyer / seller imbalance**) as the example.

1 Column

The Most active column that was used to sort the stocks. The grey line under it says what it measures, e.g. "more buyers waiting (bullish) / sellers (bearish)".

2 Finds the trend?

The verdict, from the "Edge vs all" number:

- **Strong** 10 points or more better than all stocks
- **Some** 5 to 9 points better
- **Weak** 1 to 4 points better
- **No help** not better at all
- **Too few** under 30 readings: not enough to judge

3 Top kept going (close)

Of the top stocks by this column, the share that were still moving their way at the close.

Imbalance: **54%** → 54 of every 100 top picks kept going to the close.

4 Edge vs all

Top kept going **minus** all stocks kept going, in points. The heart of the test: how much better than picking at random.

54% − 36% (all stocks) = +18 points → Strong.

5 Weakest kept going

The same, for the **bottom** stocks of the same column (the ones it likes least).

Imbalance: **46%** of the weakest picks kept going.

6 Top − weakest

How well the column tells good from bad. Big and positive = the column really separates the stocks.

54% − 46% = +8. For Volume vs usual it is −2: its weakest did as well as its top, a warning sign.

7 Top, 1 hour later / Edge, 1 hour

The same two numbers, but checked one hour after the pick instead of at the close. Useful if you hold trades for about an hour.

Imbalance: **50%** one hour later, +2 over all stocks (48%): almost no edge in the first hour.

8 Top avg move to close

The average move of the top picks from the check time to the close, **signed their way** (a bearish stock that fell 1% counts as +1%).

Imbalance: +0.12%. On a ₹1,00,000 trade that is about ₹120 before charges.

9 Readings

How many top picks were measured: days × check times × top N (fewer when a scan was missing).

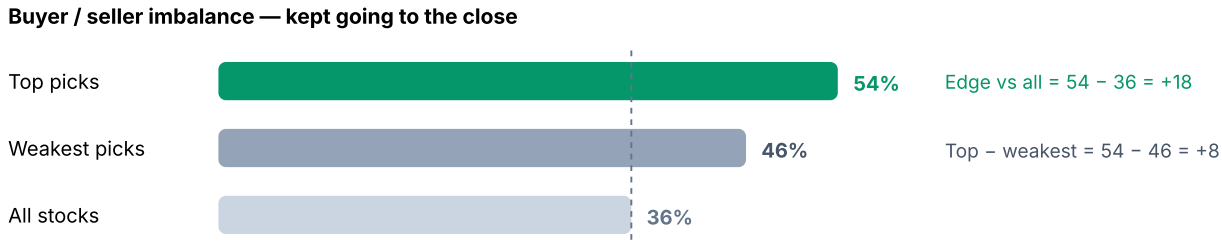
Imbalance: **121**. Fewer than 30 shows "Too few".

The line above the table

"All stocks: kept going to the close **36%** (1,141), an hour later **48%**" is the yardstick every edge is measured against.

On your days most stocks did **not** keep going to the close: many moves faded by 15:30.

One picture for the most important three numbers



A useful column has a long green bar, clearly past the dashed "all stocks" line, and a clear gap over the grey bar.

4. Reading your own results

COLUMN	VERDICT	TOP	EDGE	TOP − WEAKEST	AVG MOVE	WHAT IT SAYS
Buyer / seller imbalance	Strong	54%	+18	+8	+0.12%	The best on your days: beats the average and its top beats its bottom.
Volume vs usual	Strong	50%	+14	−2	−0.01%	Beats the average, but its *weakest* did as well and the average move is flat: high volume alone doesn't pick the trend.
All columns together	Strong	46%	+10	−4	−0.15%	Mixing every column dilutes the good one.
Day range, Speed, Money traded, Day move	Some	43-45%	+7…+10	≤ 0	mostly −	A small edge over all stocks, but they lose on the average move: not reliable.
Bias agrees, Distance from average price	Too few	–	–	–	–	0 readings: your saved scans had no average price (VWAP) for these stocks, so these two could not be tested.

In one sentence

On these days, **sorting by buyer / seller imbalance, especially in the afternoon (13:00-14:00)**, picked stocks that kept their direction to the close more often than average; the morning checks (10:00-12:00) found no useful column.

Before you trust it

- **121 readings is small.** It is a few days of scans. Let the auto scan save more days and run the test again with 20-30 days.
- **A green "Strong" is not enough on its own.** Also look for a positive "Top – weakest" and a positive "Top avg move". Volume vs usual is "Strong" but fails both.
- **Charges matter.** +0.12% average is before charges. Intraday charges are roughly 0.05-0.1% of the trade value, so the real edge is thin.
- **Past days are not a promise.** Re-run it every week or two.

5. What to do with it

1. **Watch it live first.** On the Most active card, set **Rank by → Buyer/seller imbalance** after 13:00 and note the top bullish and bearish names for a few days.
2. **Arm them on a paper bot.** Tick the top ones and press **Arm ticked** on a PAPER bot, and let the bot's own settings trade them.
3. **Back-test the other columns.** The card's **Backtest** view replays the Most active picks on past days for every column except the imbalance (Groww keeps no past order book), so the imbalance can only be proven with live paper trades.
4. **Fix the missing average price.** If the "vs avg" column on the live card is blank too, the Groww quote is not giving the average price; tell the developer, so "Bias agrees" and "Distance from average price" can be tested.

6. Words used on the screen

WORD	MEANING
Bullish / bearish	Up / down on the day (from yesterday's close) at the check time.
Top / weakest	The first / last stocks after sorting by the column (10 of each side by default).
Kept going	Still further its way later: higher for bullish, lower for bearish.
Points	The difference between two percentages: 54% vs 36% = 18 points.
Edge	How many points better than picking any stock.
Reading	One stock, one day, one check time.
Before charges	Brokerage and taxes not taken off.